

## PART A

Differentiate drift and diffusion movement of carriers in semiconductors. (3)

4 Derive continuity equation. (3)



3)

## Drift and Diffusion Currents



- **Current**

Generated by the movement of charged particles (negatively charged electrons and positively charged holes).

- **Carriers**

The charged electrons and holes are referred to as **carriers**

- The two basic processes which cause electrons and holes move in a semiconductor:

- ✓ **Drift** - the movement caused by electric field.

- ✓ **Diffusion** - the flow caused by variations in the concentration.



3)

# Drift Current Vs Diffusion Current

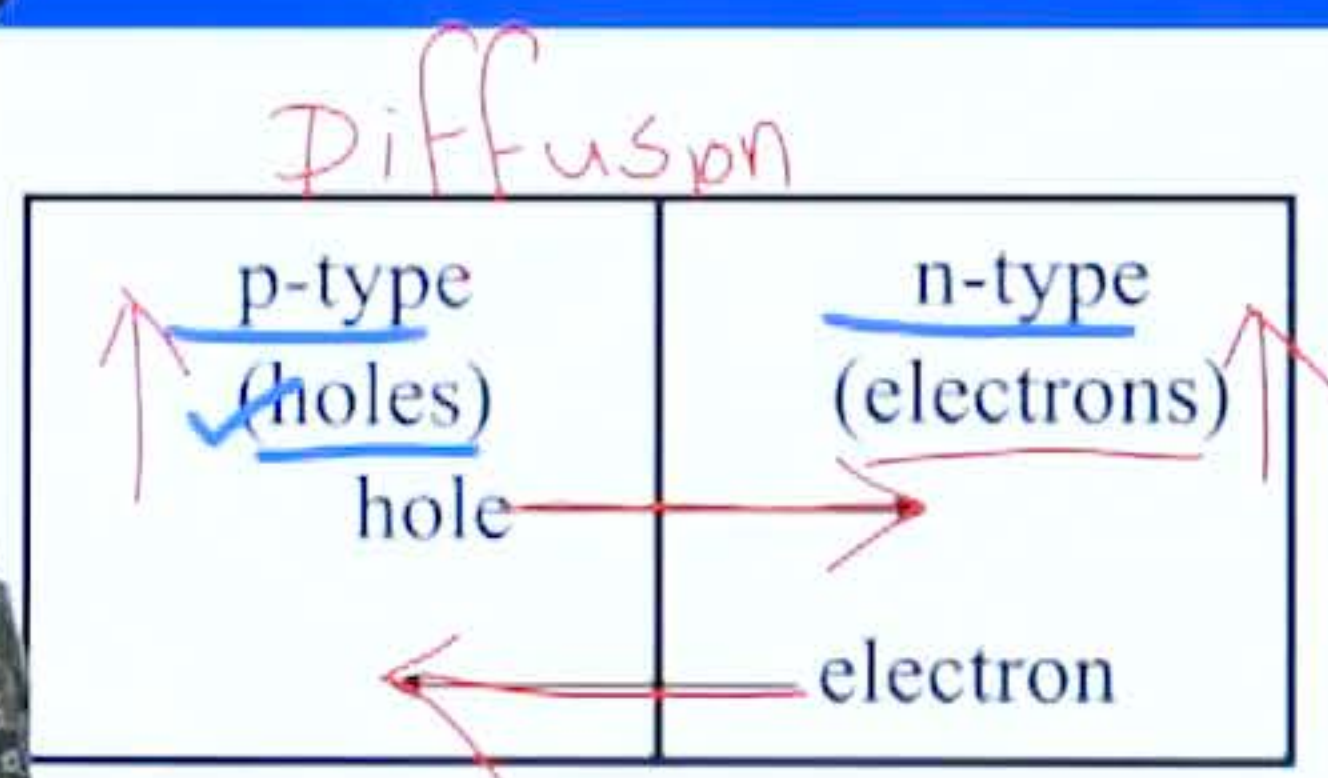


Figure - Diffusion Current

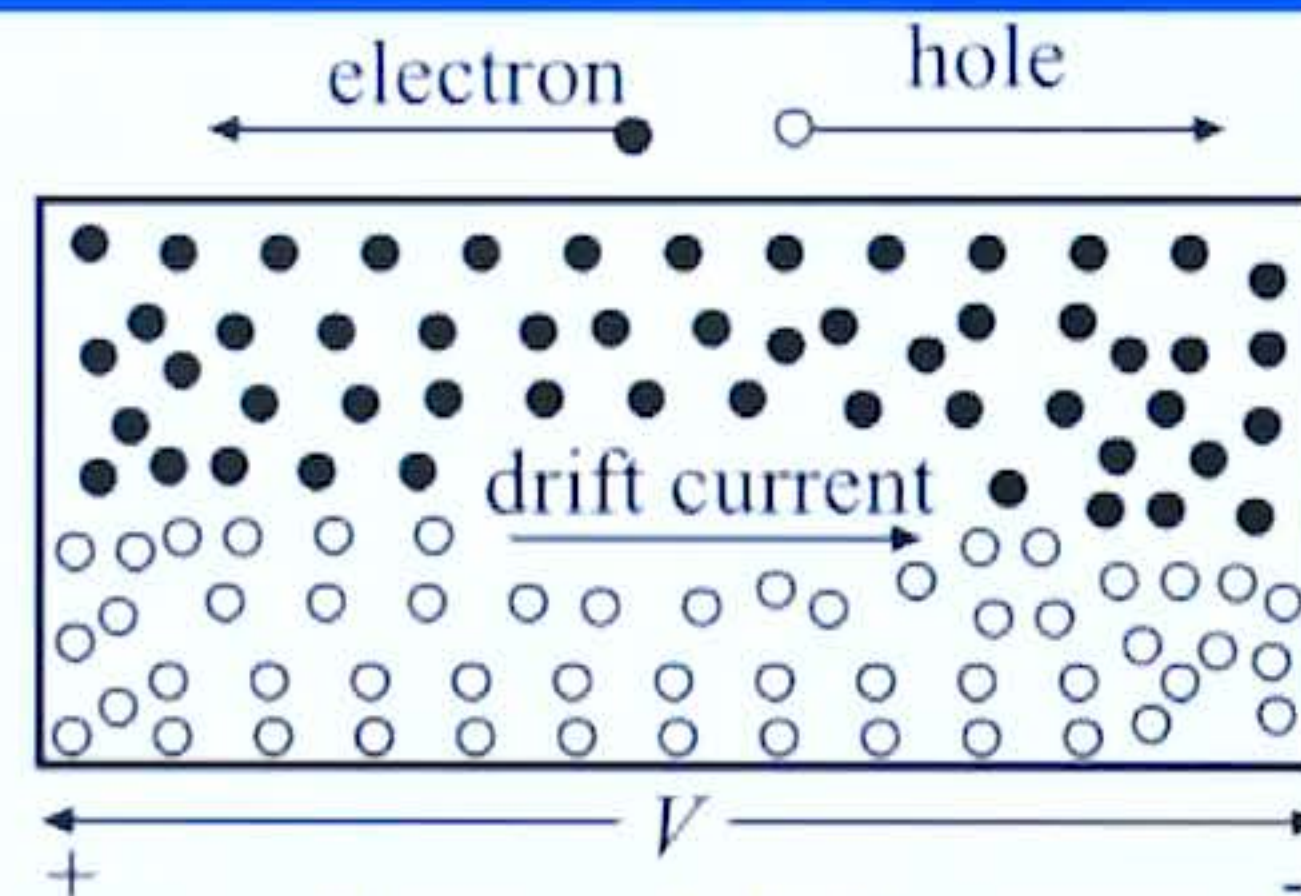


Figure - Drift Current



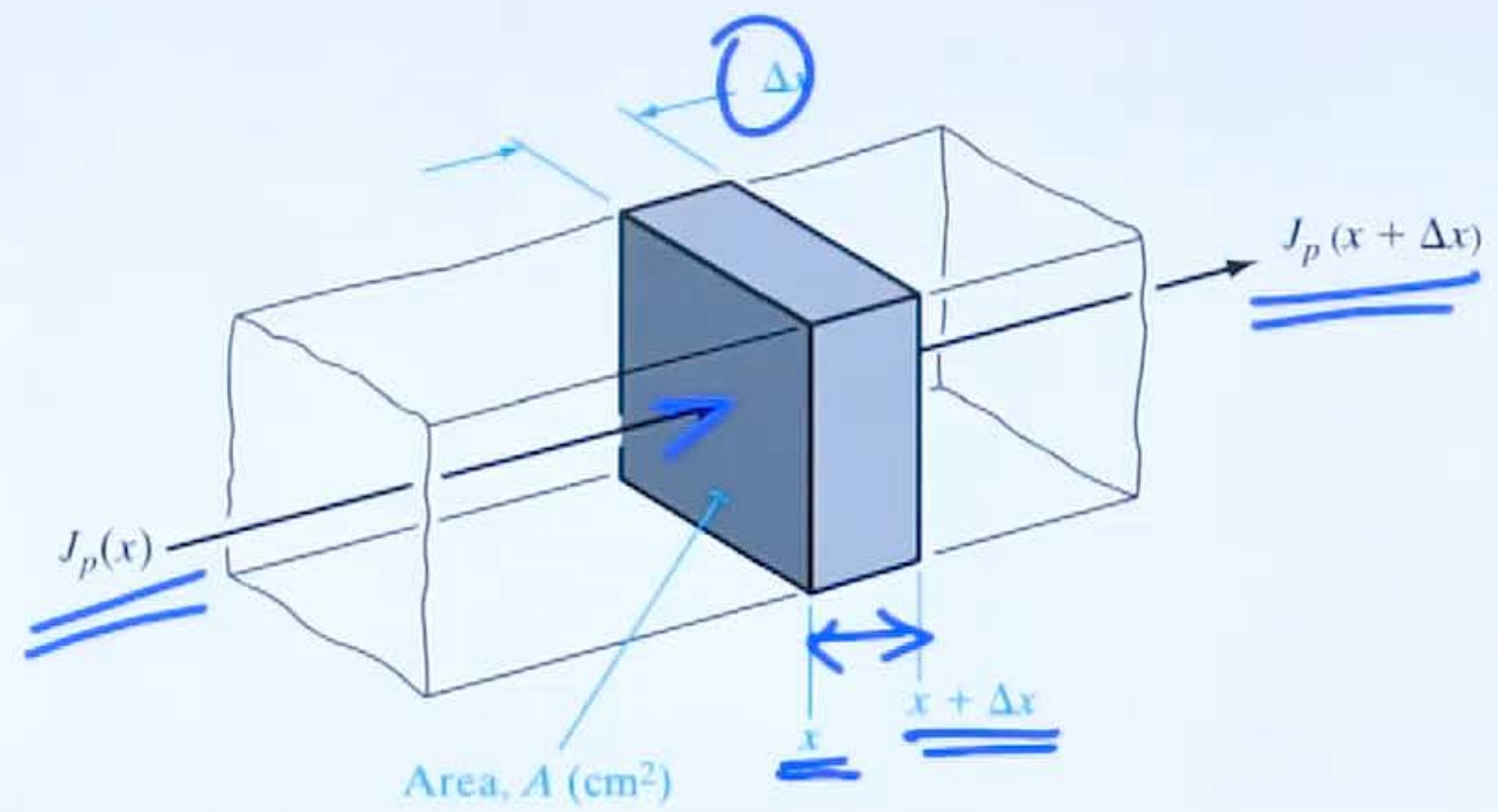
## PART A

Differentiate drift and diffusion movement of carriers in semiconductors. (3)

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4)



Current entering and leaving a volume  $\Delta x A$ .

$$\left. \frac{\partial p}{\partial t} \right|_{x \rightarrow x + \Delta x} = \frac{1}{q} \frac{J_p(x) - J_p(x + \Delta x)}{\Delta x} - \frac{\delta p}{\tau_p}$$

Rate of hole buildup = increase of hole concentration in  $\delta x A$  per unit time - recombination rate



As  $\Delta x$  approaches zero, we can write the current change in derivative form:

$$P = P_0 + \delta P \quad \checkmark$$

$$\frac{\partial p(x, t)}{\partial t} = \frac{\partial \delta p}{\partial t} = - \frac{1}{q} \frac{\partial J_p}{\partial x} - \frac{\delta p}{\tau_p}$$

The expression (4-31a) is called the continuity equation for holes. For electrons we can write

$$\frac{\partial \delta n}{\partial t} = \frac{1}{q} \frac{\partial J_n}{\partial x} - \frac{\delta n}{\tau_n} \quad \checkmark$$





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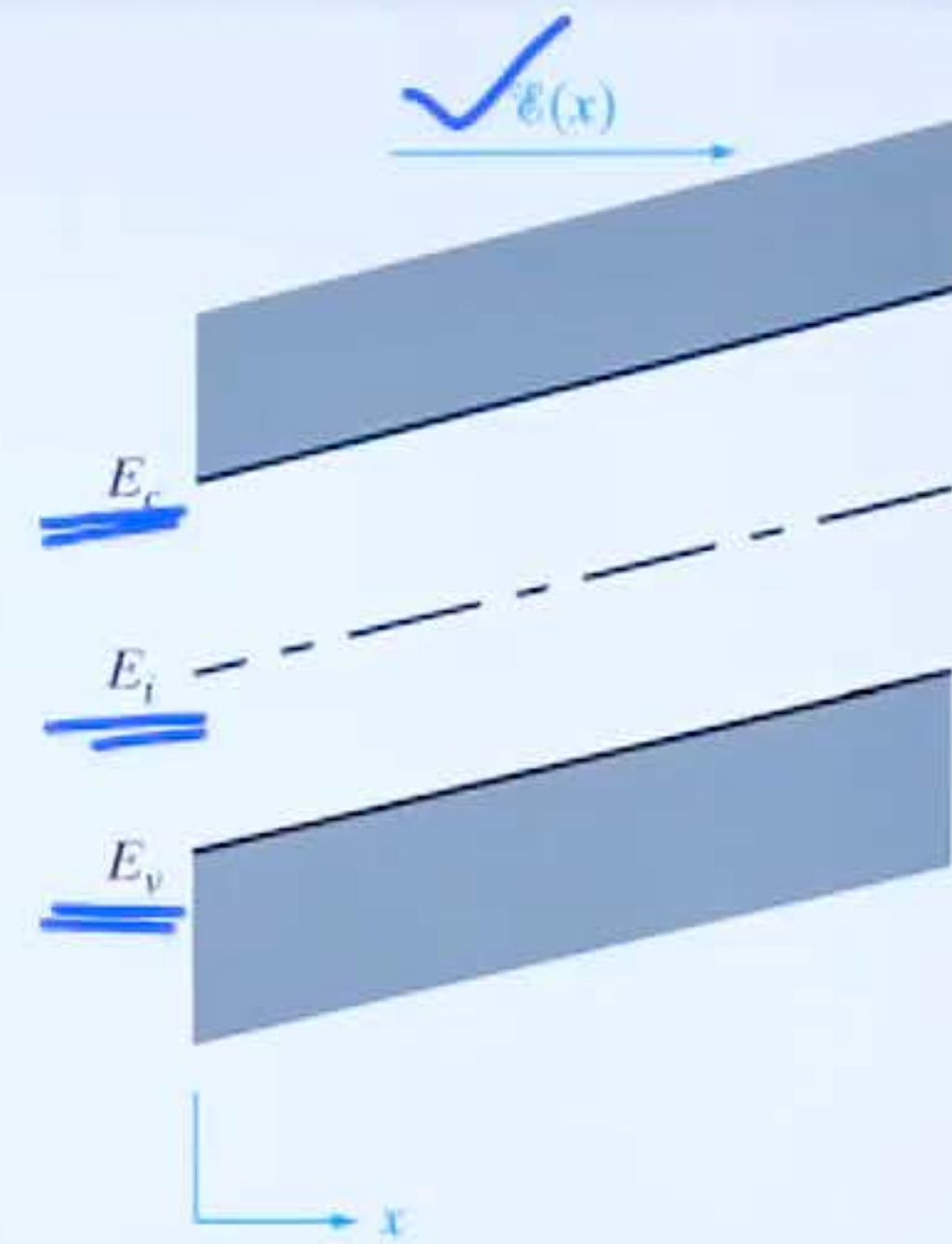
## PART B

- 13 (a) State and prove Einstein's relation. (9)
- (b) An n type silicon bar 0.1 cm long and  $100 \mu\text{m}^2$  in cross sectional area has a majority carrier concentration of  $5 \times 10^{15} \text{ cm}^{-3}$  and electron mobility  $\mu_n = 1300 \text{ cm}^2/\text{Vs}$  at 300K. What is the resistance of the bar? (5)
- 14 (a) Explain Hall Effect? Derive the expression for carrier concentration and mobility in terms of Hall voltage. (7)
- (b) Derive the expression for diffusion current density in a semiconductor. (7)



13 a)

Energy band diagram of a semiconductor in an electric field  $\mathcal{E}(x)$ .



From the definition of electric field,

$$\underline{\underline{\mathcal{E}(x)}} = - \underline{\underline{\frac{dV(x)}{dx}}}$$



$$\mathcal{E}(x) = -\frac{dV(x)}{dx} = -\frac{d}{dx} \left[ \frac{E_i}{(-q)} \right] = \frac{1}{q} \frac{dE_i}{dx} \quad \text{--- (1)}$$

*Drift*

$$\underline{J_p(x)} = \underline{q\mu_p p(x)\mathcal{E}(x)} - \underline{qD_p \frac{dp(x)}{dx}} = 0$$

Equating to zero at equilibrium

$$\mathcal{E}(x) = \frac{D_p}{\mu_p} \underline{\frac{1}{p(x)} \frac{dp(x)}{dx}}$$



Using

$$p_0 = n_i e^{(E_i - E_F)/kT}$$

$$\mathcal{E}(x) = \frac{D_p}{\mu_p} \left\{ \frac{1}{kT} \left( \frac{dE_i}{dx} - \frac{dE_F}{dx} \right) \right\}$$

On simplification

$$\frac{D}{\mu} = \frac{kT}{q}$$

$$\frac{D_p}{\mu_p} \cdot \frac{1}{kT} \cdot q \mathcal{E}(x)$$

$$\frac{D_p}{\mu_p} \cdot \frac{1 \cdot q}{kT} = 1$$



## PART B

- 3 (a) State and prove Einstein's relation. (9)
- (b) An n type silicon bar 0.1 cm long and  $100 \mu\text{m}^2$  in cross sectional area has a majority carrier concentration of  $5 \times 10^{15} \text{ cm}^{-3}$  and electron mobility  $\mu_n = 1300 \text{ cm}^2/\text{Vs}$  at 300K. What is the resistance of the bar? (5)
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13 b)

Resistivity  
~~Conductivity~~  $\rho = 1/(qn_0\mu_n) = \frac{1}{\sigma}$

Resistance of the bar,  $R = \rho L/A$ .  
 $L = 0.1 \text{ cm}$   
 $A = 100 \text{ mm}^2$

$$\sigma = n_0 q \mu_n$$

$$\rho = \frac{1}{\sigma} = \frac{1}{n_0 q \mu_n}$$

$$n_0 = 5 \times 10^{15}$$

$$q = 1.6 \times 10^{-19}$$

$$\mu_n = 1300$$



# PART B

13 (a) State and prove Einstein's relation.

$$D = \frac{KT}{q} = V_T$$

(9)

(b) An n type silicon bar 0.1 cm long and 100  $\mu\text{m}^2$  in cross sectional area has a majority carrier concentration of  $5 \times 10^{15} \text{ cm}^{-3}$  and electron mobility  $\mu_n = 1300 \text{ cm}^2/\text{Vs}$  at 300K. What is the resistance of the bar?

(5)

14 (a) Explain Hall Effect? Derive the expression for carrier concentration and mobility in terms of Hall voltage.

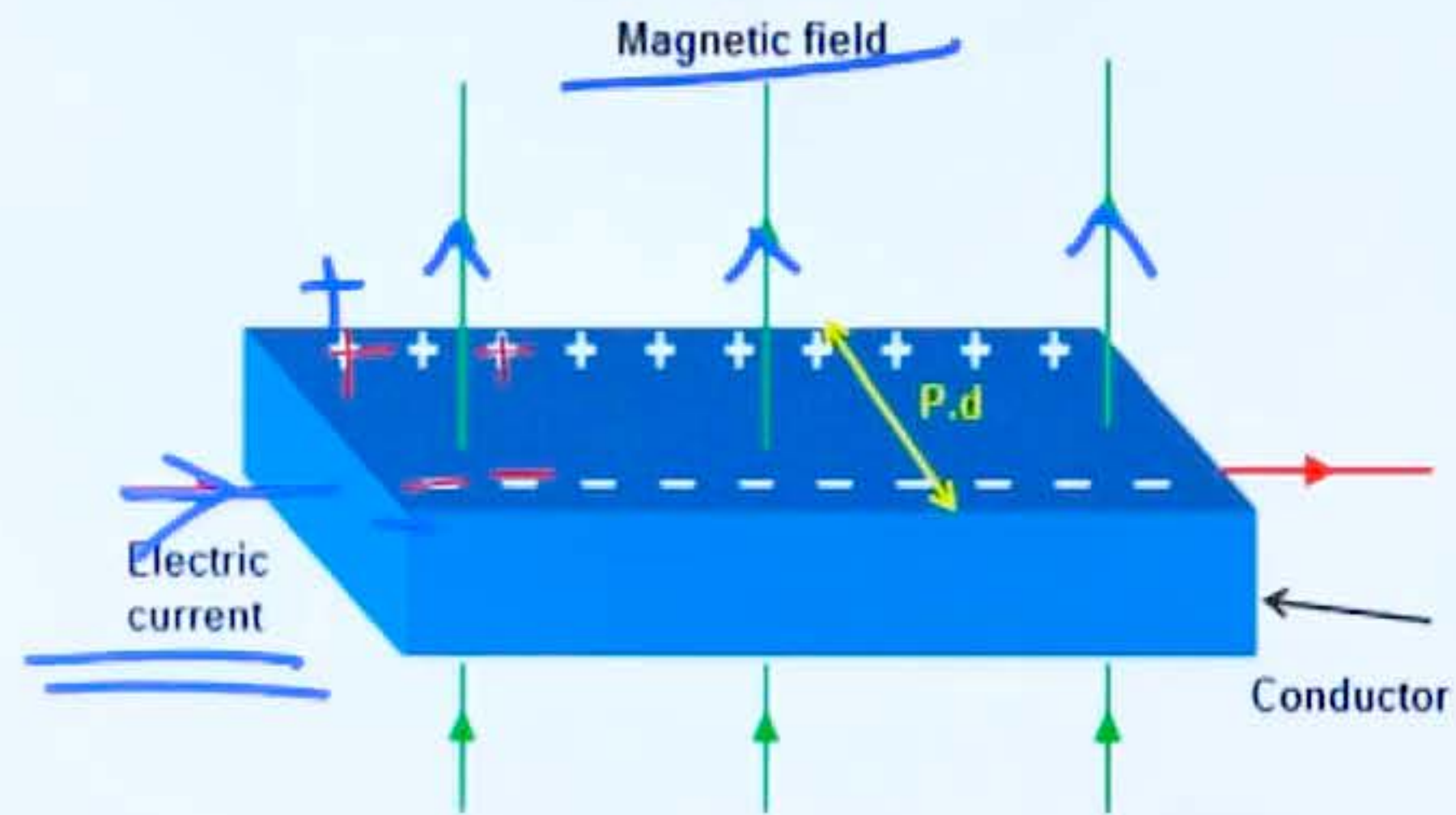
(7)

(b) Derive the expression for diffusion current density in a semiconductor.

(7)



- 14 a) When a magnetic field is applied to a current carrying conductor in a direction perpendicular to that of the flow of current, a potential difference or transverse electric field is created across a conductor. This phenomenon is known as Hall Effect.



P.d = Potential difference

Hall Effect



Under equilibrium conditions, the force on the charges due to HALL electric field and LORENTZ force counterbalances each other, that is

$$qE_y = qv_x B_z \quad \text{----- (1)}$$

$$E_y = v_x B_z \quad \text{----- (2)}$$

We know that the CURRENT DENSITY ' $J_x$ ' is given by

$$J_x = pq v_x \quad \text{----- (3)}$$

$$v_x = \frac{J_x}{pq} \quad \text{----- (4)}$$

$$\xrightarrow{I} x \quad v_x$$

$$\checkmark E_y = \frac{J_x B_z}{pq} = \underline{\underline{J_x R_H B_z}}$$

$$\frac{1}{pq} = \underline{\underline{R_H}}$$



Where  $R_H$  is Hall coefficient.

$$R_H = \frac{1}{pq}$$

$$P = \frac{1}{R_H \cdot q}$$

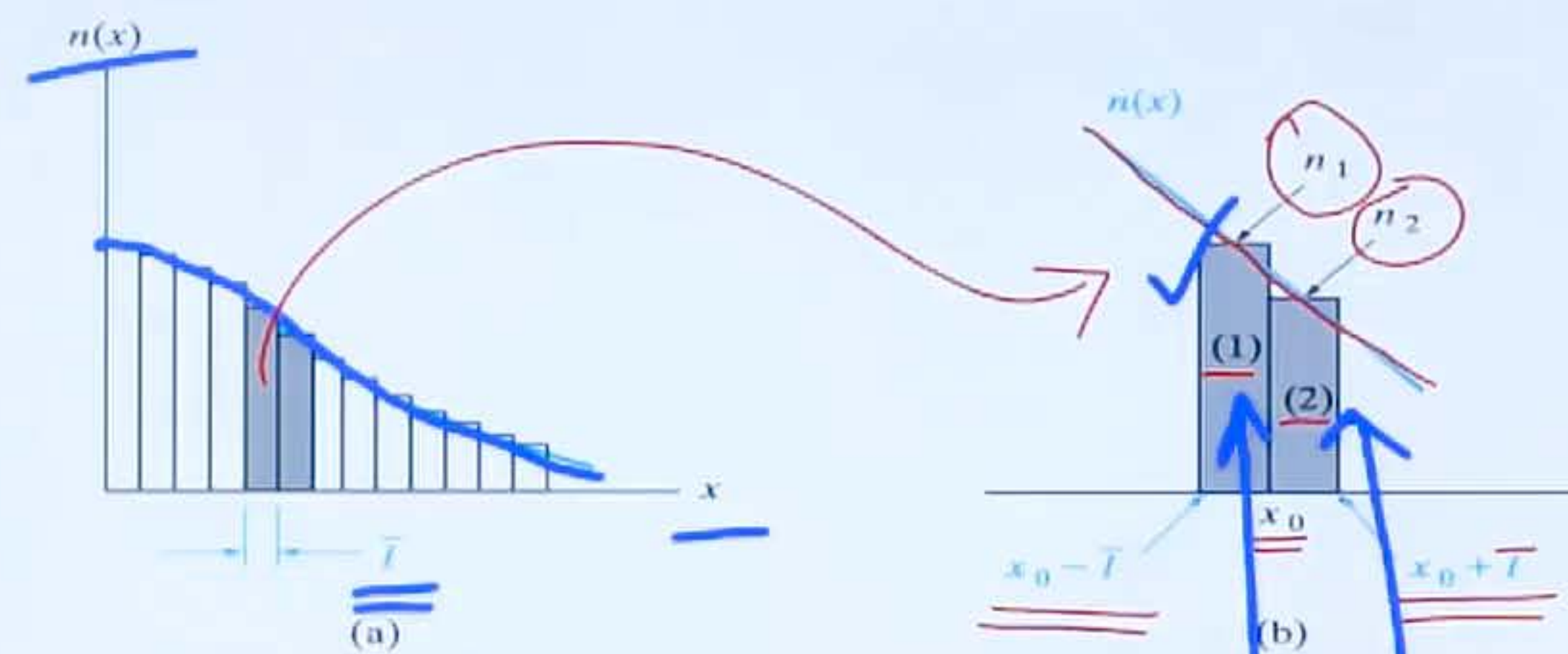
Conductivity,  $\sigma = pq\mu_p$

$$\mu_p = \frac{\sigma}{pq} = \sigma \cdot R_H = \frac{R_H}{\rho}$$

$$\mu_p = \sigma R_H = \frac{R_H}{\rho}$$



14 b)



The electrons in segment (1) to the left of  $x_0$  in Fig. 4-13b have equal chances of moving left or right, and in a mean free time  $\bar{t}$  one-half of them will move into segment (2). The same is true of electrons within one mean free path of  $x_0$  to the right; one-half of these electrons will move through  $x_0$  from right to left in a mean free time. Therefore, the net number of electrons passing  $x_0$  from left to right in one mean free time is  $\frac{1}{2}(n_1 l A) - \frac{1}{2}(n_2 l A)$ , where the area perpendicular to  $x$  is  $A$ . The rate of electron flow in the  $+x$ -direction per unit area (the electron flux density  $\phi_n$ ) is given by

$$\phi_n(x_0) = \frac{\bar{t}}{2l}(n_1 - n_2) \quad (4-18)$$





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Since the mean free path  $\bar{l}$  is a small differential length, the difference in electron concentration ( $n_1 - n_2$ ) can be written as

$$\underline{n_1 - n_2} = \frac{n(x) - n(x + \Delta x)}{\Delta x} \bar{l} \quad \checkmark \quad (4-19)$$

where  $x$  is taken at the center of segment (1) and  $\Delta x = \bar{l}$ . In the limit of small  $\Delta x$  (i.e., small mean free path  $\bar{l}$  between scattering collisions), Eq. (4-18) can be written in terms of the carrier gradient  $dn(x)/dx$ :

$$\phi_n(x) = \frac{\bar{l}^2}{2\bar{l}} \lim_{\Delta x \rightarrow 0} \frac{n(x) - n(x + \Delta x)}{\Delta x} = \frac{-\bar{l}^2}{2\bar{l}} \frac{dn(x)}{dx} \quad (4-20)$$

Diffusion Coefficient



The diffusion current crossing a unit area (the current density) is the particle flux density multiplied by the charge of the carrier:

$$\checkmark \underline{\underline{J_n(\text{diff.})}} = -(\underline{\underline{-q}})D_n \frac{dn(x)}{dx} = +qD_n \frac{dn(x)}{dx} \quad (4-22a)$$

$$\checkmark \underline{\underline{J_p(\text{diff.})}} = -(\underline{\underline{+q}})D_p \frac{dp(x)}{dx} = \underline{\underline{-qD_p \frac{dp(x)}{dx}}} \quad (4-22b)$$